mitra BETA

PRODUCT DOCUMENT

# Mitra: find collabs in one go.

A collab marketplace for Bengaluru's Kannada and English Instagram creators and the cafés, salons, gyms and brands they post about. Creators get every collab that fits their profile in one place; businesses get the creators who fit them, and a count of the customers each post brings.

Status as of 22 October 2026 · Built and tested on the **dev** branch · Not yet in production (waiting on the go-ahead)

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1 · SUMMARY

# What Mitra is, in one page

**The problem.** Small creators in Bengaluru find paid collabs by chance: scattered DMs, WhatsApp forwards and agencies, many of them scams that ask for a "registration fee". Local businesses pay creators in cash or free meals and have no idea whether a post brought anyone through the door.

**The product.** Mitra puts both sides on one list, matched to each other:

- **Creators** connect Instagram once. Mitra reads their numbers (followers, average views, engagement, audience) and fills in their profile. They then see every brand, affiliate programme and local business that fits them, best fit first, with the reasons, and say "I'm interested" in one tap.
- **Businesses and brands** add their profile once and appear to creators straight away. They see the creators interested in them and the creators who fit their area and category. Every creator post can carry a coupon counted at the counter, so the owner knows the customers and cost per customer for each creator.

**Where and for whom.** Bengaluru first, in Kannada and English, Instagram only for launch. Free for creators forever; free for businesses during the pilot.

**How Mitra makes money.** Businesses pay a monthly plan (₹499 or ₹1,499) once the pilot ends. Mitra never takes a cut of a creator's fee, so there is no reason to take deals off the platform.

MAIN FEATURE

**Collabs matched to your profile**, both sides, ranked with reasons.

PROOF FOR OWNERS

**Customer counter**: a coupon per post, redeemed at the counter with a PIN.

TRUST

**Verified numbers** from Instagram, and a **scam check** for any offer.

## Status at a glance

| AREA | STATE |
|---|---|
| Creator flow (Instagram connect, auto-filled profile, collabs list, programmes) | Built, tested on dev |
| Business flow (profile, listing, interested creators, briefs, invites, deal room, customer counter) | Built, tested on dev |
| Admin (members, pilot numbers, programmes, waitlist) | Built, tested on dev |
| Landing page (collabs-first, Beta label, English and Kannada) | Built, tested on dev |
| Instagram live connection | Needs the Meta app and App Review |
| Production deploy | Waiting on the founder's go-ahead |

# Three kinds of people use Mitra

| WHO | WHAT THEY WANT | WHAT MITRA GIVES THEM |
|---|---|---|
| **Creators** Instagram, Kannada and English, Bengaluru | Paid or barter collabs that fit their content and area, without chasing DMs or getting scammed. | A list of collabs ranked to their profile, a verified media kit, invites with clear terms, a deal log, an offer scam check. |
| **Local businesses** Cafés, darshinis, salons, gyms, boutiques | Creators near them who bring real customers, and proof of what each post did. | Interested and matched creators, briefs and invites, a coupon per post counted at the counter, cost per customer. |
| **Brands and agencies** | Many creators who fit a campaign, quickly. | The same business tools, labelled "Brand" for creators, with open briefs shown as "looking for creators now". |
| **Admins** The Mitra team | See who joined, what they use and whether the pilot is working. | An admin-only dashboard: members, pilot numbers, programmes, waitlist. |

## Principles the product follows

- **Collabs first.** The first thing either side sees is who fits them.
- **Honest numbers.** Connected numbers are "Verified"; typed numbers are labelled "Self-reported". Nobody is fooled, so nobody is let down.
- **Read-only, never posts.** Mitra reads public account numbers and never posts or messages for anyone.
- **Creators never pay and keep 100%.** No joining fee, no cut of deals.
- **Kannada and English.** Every screen in both; the user switches any time.
- **Neutral design.** The logo is the only colour; the page is about the content.
- **Paid posts are labelled** "Paid partnership" or #ad, as the ASCI rules require.

# From the landing page to a collab

Landing: "Find your collabs in one go" → Join the pilot (waitlist) →
Create free account (Google sign-in) → Pick role and language → Connect Instagram →
Collabs for you → "I'm interested" → Invite, deal room, paid

## Creator home

1. **Free during the pilot** notice, with what is coming next (Creator Pro, Agency).
2. **Connect Instagram** card, until the account is verified.
3. **Collabs for you**: every listed business and brand, best fit first. Each card shows the category, a "New" tag for the first week, the reasons it fits, links to its website and Instagram, and an "I'm interested" button. New businesses appear here the moment they save their profile.
4. **Invites** from businesses, with the fee, bonus or barter.
5. **Open programmes**: 10 real programmes to start (Wishlink, Myntra Ultimate Glam Clan, Meesho Creator Club, Amazon Associates India, Flipkart Affiliate, EarnKaro, Cuelinks, vCommission, Involve Asia, and local Bengaluru businesses on Mitra), each with "I'm interested" and a link.
6. **Offer check, media kit and deal log** shortcuts, with earnings and open deals.

## How collabs are ranked for a creator

| SIGNAL | POINTS | REASON SHOWN ON THE CARD |
|---|---|---|
| Business is in the creator's area | +3 | "In Jayanagar, your area" |
| Business category matches the creator's niche (café → food, gym → fitness, salon → beauty…) | +3 | "Fits your food content" |
| Business has open briefs | +2 | "Looking for creators now" / "2 open briefs" |
| Business joined in the last 7 days | +1 | "New" tag |

Budgets, contacts and WhatsApp numbers are never shown on these cards. A business can unlist itself at any time.

# One tap fills the profile

Instagram is the only platform for launch. YouTube was removed from the creator flow (the code is kept for later). Connecting uses the official **Instagram API with Instagram Login**, read-only, for creator and business (professional) accounts.

### What Mitra reads

- Username, name, bio, profile photo
- Followers, following, number of posts
- Last 12 posts: caption, link, likes, comments, **views**
- Where followers are: top cities, age groups, % women (accounts with 100+ followers)

### What Mitra works out

- **Average views**: the middle value of recent reels' views
- **Engagement rate**: likes + comments per post ÷ followers
- **Posts a week** and **share of reels**
- **Audience**: e.g. "Bengaluru 60% · 25–34 50% · 55% women"

### Profile auto-fill

On connect, Mitra fills every empty profile field from Instagram: name, one-line bio, niches (from the bio, captions and hashtags), languages (Kannada script or English) and Bengaluru area (from 30 neighbourhood names in the bio or captions). **It never overwrites anything the creator typed.** A creator without a profile gets one made. The creator then checks it and can change anything.

### Rules

- Permissions: `instagram_business_basic` (profile, posts) and `instagram_business_manage_insights` (views, audience). Nothing that posts or messages.
- The access token is stored encrypted and refreshed before it expires (about 60 days).
- Verified numbers last 30 days, then the Verified mark is removed unless the creator taps Refresh.
- Disconnect removes the token and the verified numbers at once.
- Not ready to connect? The creator can type handle, followers and average views, shown as "Self-reported".
- Personal Instagram accounts are asked to switch to a creator account (free in Instagram settings).

**Where verified numbers appear:** the creator's media kit, their public kit page (if they make it public), the business's creator cards ("12.5K on Instagram (verified) · 6K average views · 4.8% engagement · 60% of followers in Bengaluru") and the admin members list.

# Creators who fit you. Customers you can count.

Landing: "Sign up your business, free" → Google sign-in → Role and language →
Business profile (listed for creators at once) → Interested and matched creators →
Brief or tracked post → Customers counted

## Business home

- **Interested in you**: creators who tapped "I'm interested", newest first, with their kit, verified reach and why they fit.
- **Creators who fit you**: creators who switched on "Let local businesses find me" and fit the business's area or category (same area +3, matching niche +3, verified +2; shown at 3 points or more).
- **Briefs**: what the business wants (goal, niches, languages, deliverables, budget). Mitra suggests matching creators, and the business sends invites with a base fee or barter plus an optional bonus per customer up to a cap.
- **Deal room**: messages, terms, promo code and results, shared by both sides once an invite is accepted. The creator's WhatsApp is shared only then.

## Customer counter (Track)

1. The business adds a creator post (paid or barter, found on Mitra or not) and gets a short link.
2. Each visitor who opens the link gets a coupon on their phone.
3. At the counter, staff redeem it with the counter PIN, or type the code in counter mode (with a 10-minute undo).
4. The owner sees customers per creator and cost per customer, e.g. "41 customers · ₹154 per customer".
5. A daily-count CSV can be checked against the bill book.

Safety: the PIN is stored as a one-way hash; 5 tries per coupon; counting pauses after 20 wrong tries per business in an hour.

# Offer check, media kit, deal log, programmes

### Offer check (inbox)

A creator pastes, forwards (WhatsApp or email) or screenshots any offer. Mitra flags scam patterns (registration or "security" fees, upfront payments), checks the sender (when the website was registered, whether the domain has email, whether it matches the brand's official site, and what other creators reported), points out missing terms (fee, date, usage rights) and drafts a reply. It is free forever; it is now a secondary feature, not the headline.

### Media kit

One page per creator: name, area, niches, languages, verified numbers, rates. Mitra shows what similar creators nearby charge once at least 5 have shared rates. The creator chooses whether the kit is public ( `/kit/name` ) and whether businesses can find them.

### Deal log

A private record of every offer and deal: status, terms, promo code, payment and notes, with total earned.

### Programmes

Admin-curated list of brand, affiliate and platform programmes. Creators mark interest; admins see which programmes attract creators and use it to decide whom to bring onto Mitra first.

### Languages

Every screen exists in English and Kannada; the landing page leads with a Kannada line. The Kannada copy is a first draft and needs a native speaker's review before launch.

# Admin-only dashboard

When the marketplace is on, `/dashboard` is for admins only (set by `ADMIN_EMAILS`). Creators and businesses who open it are sent to their app home.

| PAGE | WHAT IT SHOWS |
|---|---|
| **Members** | Every creator, brand and business: role, email, language, area, niches or category, Instagram numbers (verified or self-reported), open to offers, public kit, listed, plan and the plan they said they'd pay for, joined, last seen, and usage (interests, programmes, offers checked, briefs, tracked posts, deals). Filter by role, search by name, email or area. |
| **Pilot numbers** | Launch interest (waitlist by role, accounts by role, programme interest) and the five pilot numbers below, with an 8-week trend and the bill-check CSV. |
| **Open programmes** | Add, edit, hide and reorder programmes creators see. |
| **Waitlist** | Everyone who joined the pilot list, and invites. |

## The five pilot numbers (targets by 16 December)

| # | NUMBER | TARGET |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | Businesses counting: a customer redeemed in the last 14 days | 20 (stretch 30) |
| 2 | Customers per post (median, posts 3+ days old) | 30+ posts; within ~20% of bills at 3 venues |
| 3 | Businesses paying (paid plans only) | 5–10, any price |
| 4 | Repeat rate: a second post 1–30 days after the first | 50% or more |
| 5 | Creators using the offer inbox without a founder DM | 100+ |

Admin accounts are left out of every number.

# Businesses pay a plan. Creators never pay.

| PLAN | PRICE / MONTH | INCLUDES |
|---|---|---|
| Free | ₹0 | 2 tracked posts a month |
| Local | ₹499 | Unlimited tracked posts, 3 creator matches a month |
| Growth | ₹1,499 | Unlimited tracked posts and matches |

- **During the pilot everything is free.** Plans are shown and "I'd pay for this" is recorded to measure willingness to pay; nothing is charged.
- **No cut of deals.** Creators keep their full fee and any customer bonus. Charging the business a flat plan instead of a commission removes the reason to deal off-platform.
- **Deal terms** supported: base fee, barter, and a bonus per customer up to a cap; Mitra shows the cost per customer.
- **Coming next** (shown in the app as "coming"): Creator Pro and an Agency plan.

9 · PRIVACY, SAFETY AND COMPLIANCE

## Read-only, encrypted, deletable

- Instagram and session tokens are stored encrypted or hashed; Mitra never posts.
- Verified numbers expire after 30 days; disconnecting removes them immediately.
- A creator's email and WhatsApp go to a business only after the creator accepts its invite.
- Businesses see only creators who opted in to be found, or who said they're interested.
- The privacy policy lists the Instagram data read, why, how long it is kept, and Meta as a processor.
- Paid posts carry "Paid partnership" or #ad (ASCI).
- Reports about offer senders are shown only as counts, and only once two different creators agree.

10 · HOW IT IS BUILT

## Technology

| PART | CHOICE |
|---|---|
| App | Next.js 16 (React), server-rendered pages, one codebase for landing, app and admin |
| Data | Postgres (Neon, Singapore) with Drizzle; embedded database locally and in tests; migrations 0012–0019, all additive, run on deploy |
| Hosting | Vercel; the `prod` branch is production, `dev` is the preview |
| Sign-in | Google (email and profile only) |
| Instagram | Instagram API with Instagram Login, Graph API v23.0 |
| Quality | 19 automated test suites (matching, Instagram reads, profile fill, counting, pilot numbers, programmes, privacy rules), type checks, lint, production build, and browser end-to-end checks on desktop and phone |
| Branches | `dev`: the launch product · `analytics-dashboard`: a copy of the previous production product (YouTube analytics), kept for later |

# What's left before production

| # | STEP | OWNER |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | **Meta app** with the Instagram product; add `INSTAGRAM_APP_ID` and `INSTAGRAM_APP_SECRET` to Vercel; redirect URL `https://trymitraapp.com/api/auth/instagram/callback` | Founder |
| 2 | **Submit Meta App Review** for both permissions (privacy policy URL, screencast of connect → profile filled). Usually 1–2 weeks; until then only Instagram testers can connect, everyone else types their numbers. | Founder, day 1 |
| 3 | Vercel production variables: `NEXT_PUBLIC_MARKETPLACE=1`, `NEXT_PUBLIC_INVITE_ONLY=0`, `ADMIN_EMAILS`, `APP_URL` | Founder |
| 4 | Google consent screen set to "In production" (sign-in only, no Google review needed) | Founder |
| 5 | Co-founder's name for the "Who's behind Mitra" section; WhatsApp support number | Founder |
| 6 | Native Kannada speaker reviews all copy | Team in India |
| 7 | Merge `dev` into `prod` and run the 15-minute smoke test on the live site | On the go-ahead |

## Launch week plan

| DAY | PRODUCT | PEOPLE (BENGALURU) |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | Production deploy after go-ahead; Meta App Review submitted | Kannada check; pick 2 neighbourhoods |
| 2 | Add first creators as Instagram testers | List 50 creators and 30 businesses |
| 3 | Smoke test; fix anything found | Sign up the first businesses (with permission) |
| 4 | Watch pilot numbers daily | Share the link in 10 creator WhatsApp groups |
| 5–7 | Small fixes only | Walk into businesses: "free creators and customer counter" |

## Main risks

- **Meta App Review delay**: creators can still join with typed numbers; testers verify meanwhile.
- **Cold start**: collabs need businesses. Mitigation: 10 programmes from day 1, and walking into local businesses in two neighbourhoods.
- **Counting accuracy**: checked against bill books at 3 venues.
- **Cost to sign up a business** (rep hours, travel, standees): tracked weekly outside the app; the number most likely to break the model.

### After the pilot

- Turn on paid business plans; Creator Pro and Agency plans.
- Payments inside Mitra for fees and customer bonuses.
- More platforms (YouTube again) once Instagram works.
- More neighbourhoods, then more cities.